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United States : Governor Newsom Announces New State Sites Identified for Affordable Housing, Signs Legislation to Boost Housing on State Property

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Governor Gavin Newsom today announced that the California Department of Housing and Community Development (HCD) and the California Department of General Services (DGS) are seeking qualified developers to develop housing on five state-owned properties. This is the latest offering under one of the first executive orders (N-06-19) that Governor Newsom issued upon taking office in 2019, creating the Excess Land for Affordable Housing program. To date, this successful program has brought 16 partnerships between the state, affordable housing developers, and local communities to produce sustainable, innovative, and cost-effective housing on state-owned excess sites, creating a pipeline of more than 4,400 new homes in various stages of development.

Governor Newsom also announced the signing of SB 561 by Senator Bill Dodd (D-Napa), AB 2233 by Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva (D-Fullerton), and AB 2592 by Assemblymember Kevin McCarty (D-Sacramento) all passed by the Legislature to create more affordable housing, and codify and build upon the success of the Excess Land for Affordable Housing program.

Californias housing affordability crisis has been more than a half century in the making and the state is tackling this foundational challenge with an innovative all of the above approach, said Governor Newsom. Weve made unprecedented investments and progress to create more housing in California over the past four years, including using state-owned land to build homes one of my first actions in 2019. Im thankful to Senator Dodd, Assemblymember Quirk-Silva, and Assemblymember McCarty for their efforts in helping us fast-track our progress and bring more affordable housing statewide.

The sites announced today aim to create hundreds of new housing units for low-income Californians. They include former office buildings of the state Water Resources Board in Fresno, former offices of the Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation in Covina, a single-story commercial building in Midtown Sacramento, a vacant California Department of Transportation site in Oceanside, and a buffer zone near the Atascadero State Hospital in Atascadero.

SB 561 codifies the Excess Land for Affordable Housing Executive Order by requiring DGS and HCD to identify state surplus land that can be used for affordable housing development.

AB 2233 also helps to codify the executive order, requires the California Housing Finance Agency, HCD, and DGS to identify and prioritize surplus properties that can be used for cost effective housing developments and it generates a progress report to the Legislature.

AB 2592 requires DGS to prepare a report to the Legislature on a streamlined plan to transition underutilized multistory state buildings into housing for the purpose of expanding affordable housing and adaptive reuse

opportunities.

A full list of bills signed by Governor Newsom can be found below:

AB 58 by Assemblymember Rudy Salas (D-Bakersfield) Pupil health: suicide prevention policies and training.

AB 392 by Assemblymember Adrin Nazarian (D-North Hollywood) Clinical laboratories: total protein test: authorization.

AB 498 by Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva (D-Fullerton) Medi-Cal: county organized health system: Orange County Health Authority.

AB 748 by Assemblymember Wendy Carrillo (D-Los Angeles) Pupil mental health: mental health assistance posters.

AB 1628 by Assemblymember James C. Ramos (D-Highland) Social media platforms: electronic content management: controlled substances.

AB 1832 by Assemblymember Luz Rivas (D-Arleta) Waters subject to tidal influence: hard mineral extraction.

AB 1867 by Assemblymember Alex Lee (D-San Jose) School facilities: modernization projects: bathrooms.

AB 1932 by Assemblymember Tom Daly (D-Anaheim) Public contracts: construction manager at-risk construction contracts.

AB 2000 by Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel (D-Encino) Motor vehicle speed contests and exhibitions of speed: offstreet parking facilities.

AB 2109 by Assemblymember Steve Bennett (D-Ventura) White sharks: prohibition on use of attractants.

AB 2233 by Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva (D-Fullerton) Excess state land: development of affordable housing.

AB 2592 by Assemblymember Kevin McCarty (D-Sacramento) Housing: underutilized state buildings.

AB 2648 by Assemblymember Lori Wilson (D-Suisun City) Air ambulance services.

AB 2681 by Assemblymember Richard Bloom (D-Santa Monica) The California Concert and Festival Crowd Safety Act.

AB 2777 by Assemblymember Buffy Wicks (D-Oakland) Sexual assault: statute of limitations.

AB 2955 by the Committee on Labor and Employment Worker classification: commercial fishing industry.

AB 2959 by the Committee on Judiciary Childhood sexual assault: claims.

SB 45 by Senator Anthony Portantino (D-La Caada Flintridge) Short-lived climate pollutants: organic waste reduction goals: local jurisdiction assistance.

SB 561 by Senator Bill Dodd (D-Napa) State surplus property: digital inventory: affordable housing.

SB 768 by Senator Steven Glazer (D-Orinda) CalWORKs: postsecondary education.

SB 1027 by Senator Toni G. Atkins (D-San Diego) San Diego River Conservancy.

SB 1079 by Senator Anthony Portantino (D-La Caada Flintridge) Vehicles: sound-activated enforcement devices.

SB 1453 by Senator Rosilicie Ochoa Bogh (R-Yucaipa) Speech language pathologists.

SB 1494 by the Committee on Governance and Finance Property taxation: revenue allocations: tax-defaulted property sales.

SB 1498 by the Committee on Banking and Financial Institutions Financial institutions: Department of Financial Protection and Innovation: money transmissions.

The Governor also announced that he has vetoed the following bills:

AB 552 by Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva (D-Fullerton) Integrated School-Based Behavioral Health Partnership Program. A veto message can be found here.

AB 1965 by Assemblymember Buffy Wicks (D-Oakland) California Antihunger Response Act of 2022.

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